

=====

EMANUELE "LELE" CALO'
DevOps/SRE/Infra Leader | Blockchain Infrastructure Expert

=====

CV Version: 1.6

CONTACT & LINKS

Name : Emanuele Calo'
Nickname : Lele (IRL) | eldios (online)
Location : Lucca, Italy
Email : emanuele.lele.calo@gmail.com

LinkedIn : <https://www.linkedin.com/in/emanuelecalo/>
GitHub : <https://github.com/eldios>
Personal Site : <https://lele.rip>

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

20+ years building and scaling infrastructure | 10+ years DevOps/SRE leadership
Certified Kubernetes Administrator | Blockchain infrastructure specialist
Crypto enthusiast, founder and builder | Multiple startups founding member
Tech evangelist passionate about mentoring and knowledge sharing
Hacker mindset [6] | Problem solver [5] | Fast learner

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS & NERD CREDs

- + Built infrastructure handling millions of blockchain transactions daily
- + Mentored 50+ engineers in DevOps best practices
- + Conference speaker on infrastructure and crypto/blockchain topics

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

+ HEAD OF INFRASTRUCTURE | Linera Jul 2025 - Present
<https://linera.io> | New L1 Blockchain

- Leading infrastructure architecture for groundbreaking L1 blockchain
- Designing validator/node infrastructure for distributed consensus network
- Mentoring Rust developers on infrastructure best practices
- Implementing Kubernetes, AWS, OpenTofu, ArgoCD infrastructure at scale
- Acting as Staff Engineer bridging technical teams and stakeholders

- + HEAD OF INFRASTRUCTURE | Switchboard Mar 2024 - Jul 2025
<https://switchboard.xyz> | Oracle Network on Solana
 - Led DevOps practices adoption across engineering teams
 - Architected high-availability oracle network infrastructure based on AMD SEV SNP and Intel SGX (Confidential Computing) technologies
 - Managed AWS, Kubernetes, Terraform blockchain Oracle distributed infra
 - Developed Rust and TypeScript solutions for Solana blockchain infrastructure
- + LEAD SRE | Tint Mar 2023 - Jan 2024
<https://tint.ai> | AI Platform
 - Owned cloud infrastructure decision-making and architecture
 - Built scalable Kubernetes infrastructure supporting AI workloads
 - Established SRE best practices and mentorship programs
 - Designed disaster recovery and high-availability solutions
- + SENIOR DEVOPS & SRE | Kraken Mar 2022 - Nov 2022
<https://kraken.com> | Crypto Exchange
 - CORE team member ensuring exchange reliability and security
 - Developed critical services for trading and staking systems
 - Implemented security best practices across multiple teams
 - Managed infrastructure handling billions in daily trading volume
- + SENIOR DEVOPS | Ada Jan 2021 - Mar 2022
<https://ada.cx> | Customer Service AI
 - Participated in 24/7 on-call rotation maintaining 99.9% uptime
 - Architected MongoDB clusters and AWS infrastructure
 - Mentored engineering team on Kubernetes and Terraform
 - Led infrastructure planning as Staff Engineer
- + DEVOPS & SRE | Teleport Jul 2017 - Dec 2020
<https://goteleport.com> | Security Infrastructure
 - Built secure access infrastructure for Fortune 500 companies
 - Developed Kubernetes-native security solutions
 - Implemented zero-trust network architectures
 - Contributed to open-source security tools
- + HOSTING TEAM LEADER | End Point Inc. Aug 2012 - Jun 2017
<https://endpoint.com> | E-commerce Solutions
 - Led team of 10 engineers managing enterprise hosting infrastructure
 - Automated Linux systems for large-scale web hosting
 - Implemented monitoring and alerting for 100+ client systems
- + FOUNDER | IT Consultant & Web Hosting Apr 2012 - Present
<https://sshadm.in> | Side Project
 - Managing infrastructure for personal projects and select clients
 - Stack: nixOS/Ubuntu/Enhance/Hetzner/Cloudflare/borgbackup/Docker
 - Personal side-gigs, testing, studying and experimentation venues
 - Experimental sandbox for emerging technologies

[previous positions redacted for brevity, check LinkedIn]

TECHNICAL EXPERTISE [with nerd scale 0-10] [3.b]

+ CERTIFICATIONS

- CKA - Certified Kubernetes Administrator (https://lele.rip/cka_2018.png)

+ LINUX & SYSTEMS [8/10] [1]

- NixOS/NixPkgs (primary distro, everywhere it makes sense)
- Arch Linux (secondary distro, AUR maintainer)
- Ubuntu/Debian (production standard)
- RHEL/CentOS/CloudLinux/Fedora
- Gentoo (first love distro, a bit rusty)
- BSD, SmartOS, CoreOS (experimentation)
- SELinux setup, management and configuration
- Full system encryption, IPv6 native and 6to4

+ CONTAINER & ORCHESTRATION [8/10]

- Kubernetes (k3s, k8s, KOPS, kubeadm, rancher, rke)
- Docker, rkt, Swarm, Container Security
- Helm, Kustomize, Operators
- Service Mesh (Istio, Linkerd)

+ INFRASTRUCTURE AS CODE [8/10]

- OpenTofu/Terraform (migrating from HashiCorp)
- ArgoCD, Flux, Crossplane
- Ansible, Puppet, Chef
- Packer, cloud-init

+ CLOUD PLATFORMS [8/10]

- AWS (EC2, EKS, S3, Lambda, CloudFormation, Route53, RDS, etc.)
- GCP (GKE, Cloud Run, BigQuery, Pub/Sub)
- Azure, Digital Ocean, Linode, OVH, Proxmox
- Bare Metal: OVH, Hetzner, Latitude, Teraswitch

+ HASHICORP STACK [7/10] (migrating to CNCF alternatives)

- Consul (Service Discovery)
- Vault (Secrets Management) -> OpenBao
- Nomad (Orchestration)
- Terraform -> OpenTofu
- Packer (Image Building)

+ PROGRAMMING LANGUAGES [3.a]

- 8/10: ShellScripting (bash, zsh, fish)
- 7/10: Go, Rust, Python, Ruby, Perl, NodeJS/JavaScript, TypeScript
- 6/10: Solidity (EVM), PHP, SQL (MySQL, PostgreSQL)
- 5/10: NoSQL (Redis, CouchDB/BigCouch, MongoDB)
- 4/10: Java (including Android development), C# (Unity game dev hobby)
- 3/10: C/C++

+ BLOCKCHAIN & CRYPTO

- Solana: Rust development, validator operations, on-chain programs
- Ethereum: Smart contracts, node operations, DeFi protocols
- Bitcoin/Monero: Infrastructure, security, privacy tech
- General: MEV, cross-chain bridges, oracles

- + DATABASES [2]
 - SQL: MySQL, PostgreSQL (clustering, replication, tuning)
 - NoSQL: MongoDB (sharding), Redis (sentinel, cluster), CouchDB/BigCouch
 - Time-series: Prometheus, InfluxDB, TimescaleDB
 - Graph: Neo4j, ArangoDB
- + MONITORING & OBSERVABILITY
 - Prometheus/Grafana/Alertmanager stack
 - ELK/EFK/OpenSearch
 - Nagios/Icinga, CheckMK, Zabbix
 - Datadog, New Relic, AWS CloudWatch
 - Custom metrics, SLI/SLO/SLA implementation
- + NETWORKING & SECURITY
 - VPN: OpenVPN, WireGuard, Tinc, PPTP, IPSec
 - DNS: Bind, PowerDNS, dnsmasq, CoreDNS
 - Load Balancing: HAProxy, nginx, Traefik
 - CDN: Cloudflare, Fastly, AWS CloudFront
 - Zero-trust architecture, mTLS, service mesh
- + WEB & APPLICATION SERVERS
 - HTTP: nginx, Apache, Caddy, LiteSpeed, lighttpd
 - Application: Node.js, Rails, Django, FastAPI
 - Message Queues: RabbitMQ, Kafka, Redis Pub/Sub, NATS
- + MAIL SYSTEMS
 - Postfix, Dovecot, Courier, Exim, Sendmail
 - Anti-spam: SpamAssassin, rspamd
 - DKIM, SPF, DMARC implementation
- + BACKUP & DISASTER RECOVERY
 - Borg/Borgmatic, Restic, Duplicity
 - Amanda, Bacula, BackupPC
 - Cloud: AWS Backup, GCP snapshots
 - Custom solutions with rclone, rsync
- + VIRTUALIZATION
 - QEMU/KVM, Xen, VMware vSphere
 - Proxmox, oVirt, OpenStack
 - VirtualBox, Vagrant

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Age: 42 (born 19831204 in YYYYMMDD format for the data nerds)
Family: Married, 2 sons (20 & 14), 3+ cats :3
Travel: Available for occasional travel (~bimonthly)
Languages: Italian (native), English (fluent), Tech (native)

Timezone:

- (live) UTC+1 (CET/CEST)
- (work) UTC-7 (PST/PDT)

PERSONAL INTERESTS & HACKER MINDSET

- + Scout Leader & National IT Team (CNGEI)
 - Adult trainer at national level
 - Managing association's IT infrastructure
- + Hardware Hacking & DIY
 - Arduino, Raspberry Pi, ESP8266/ESP32
 - Custom mechanical keyboards (QMK/ZMK firmware)
 - 3D printing (FDM/resin)
 - Home automation (Home Assistant, Node-RED)
 - VR development (Quest, Index)
- + Tech Ecosystem
 - Active HN/YC community member
 - Startup advisor and technical due diligence
 - Open source contributor
 - Technical blog writer (when time permits)
- + Gaming & Geek Culture
 - Paper RPG (D&D, Pathfinder, Cyberpunk)
 - Hardcore computer gamer
 - Roguelike enthusiast (Dwarf Fortress, Noita, NetHack, TOME)
 - Retro computing (Commodore, Amiga)
- + Early adopter credentials [4]:
 - Android user since v1.6 (Donut)
 - NodeJS user since v0.3.x
 - Minecraft alpha buyer (\$9.99 gang)
 - Kubernetes since v1.2
 - Docker since v0.9
 - Generally "almost-everything-which-THEN-had-huge-hype" user :)
- + Other Random Interests
 - Cats
 - Motorcycles
 - Martial arts
 - Photography

DOCUMENT VERSIONS & FORMATS

Graphical CV (PDF): https://lele.rip/Lele_CV_Otta.pdf
Text Version: https://lele.rip/Lele_CV.txt
PDF Version: https://lele.rip/Lele_CV.pdf
Photo: https://lele.rip/Lele_pic.jpg

CV History[2]: https://lele.rip/Lele_CV-1.6.txt
CV History[1]: https://lele.rip/Lele_CV-1.5.txt
CV History[0]: https://lele.rip/Lele_CV-1.4.txt

INTERNAL REFERENCES & RATING SCALE

- [1] Competent with almost every Linux distro, cross-platform environments including Windows AD and macOS for heterogeneous infrastructures
- [2] Extensive experience managing services at scale: monitoring, SQL/NoSQL databases, HTTP servers, DNS, mail, backup, VPN, version control, container orchestration, message queues, and more
- [3.a] Language proficiency includes both writing production code and debugging/optimizing existing systems
- [3.b] Rating Scale (0-10):
 - 0: No experience
 - 1-3: Can read and understand, not comfortable implementing
 - 4-6: Comfortable to very comfortable with routine work
 - 7: Deep expertise, can design and implement any project
 - 8: Go-to expert in any environment
 - 9: Published author or patent holder in the field
 - 10: Industry-recognized expert (Torvalds, Carmack, etc.)
- [4] "Early adopter" means being in production with tech before it was cool
- [5] Problem Solver as defined at <http://solversmanifesto.com>
- [6] Hacker as per [http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hacker_\(programmer_subculture\)](http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hacker_(programmer_subculture))

END OF DOCUMENT

vim: set ts=2 sw=2 cc=80 et nu list: